

DAILY SUNNAH

The Prophetic Night

40 Habits for Sleep, Rest, and the Last Third

The night, rebuilt the way it was meant to be lived: a washing, a posture, a word on the lips, a heart turned toward the last third, each habit beside the science that confirms it.

A DailySunnah Companion Book

INTRODUCTION

The Night You Were Given

Sleep is one of the quiet mercies you were handed before you ever earned it. Every night your body is set down, your senses are folded away, and something you did not build and cannot fully see goes to work repairing you.

It is 11:40 at night. You prayed Isha hours ago. The house has finally gone quiet, the phone is warm in your hand, and you are telling yourself this is the only hour of the day that belongs to you. Forty minutes later the feed has given you nothing you actually wanted, Fajr is seven hours away, and tomorrow has already been made a little smaller.

We treat the night as the part of the day that does not count. The real living happens in the light, and sleep is the tax we pay to get back to it. So we trim it, borrow against it, and scroll past its edges, and we wonder why the mornings feel like debts.

Revelation never spoke about the night that way. The night in the Qur'an is not empty. It is a garment pulled over a tired world, and sleep inside it is a mercy with a purpose.

Science arrived at the same door from the other side. For most of the last century, researchers assumed sleep was the brain switching off. It turns out to be the opposite. While you lie still, the brain is filing the day into memory, washing itself of waste, and re-tuning the emotions the day left raw. Nothing is idle in there. The stillness is the work.

INTRODUCTION

How to read this book

That is the quiet claim of this book. The Prophet ﷺ readied himself for the night with deliberate care, and fourteen centuries later the laboratory keeps confirming the wisdom of what he did. He slept early; we now know the early night carries the deepest sleep. He washed before bed; we now know a cooling body falls asleep faster. He guarded the hour after Isha; we now know light and stimulation in that last hour steal the sleep that follows.

The promise here is simple. Forty habits, small enough to start tonight, each one a prophetic practice with the science standing quietly behind it. You do not need all forty at once. Pick one. Let it settle. The night rewards the patient more than the ambitious.

And know what you are actually doing when you pick one. You are becoming a person whose night belongs to Allah: the one who lies down clean, wakes grateful, and keeps a quiet appointment before dawn that no one else knows about.

A word on the sources. Every prophetic practice here is tied to a Qur'anic verse or a hadith, and every one is marked so a human reviewer can confirm it before publication. Where a narration is less firmly established, it is described gently and flagged rather than asserted. The science is drawn from a single careful source and paired honestly, never stretched past what it says.

Let us rebuild the night.

SECTION ONE

The Wind-Down

Guarding the last hour, and letting the day come to rest

The night does not begin when your head touches the pillow. It begins an hour earlier, in how you close the day. The Prophet ﷺ gave the end of the evening a clear boundary, and sleep science has found that same boundary to be one of the most powerful levers we have.

THE WIND-DOWN

Habit 1: Sleep early, soon after Isha

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ disliked staying awake in idle talk after the night prayer and disliked sleeping before it. He preferred that the believer pray Isha and then go to rest.

THE SCIENCE. The early night is not interchangeable with the late night. Sleep is governed by an internal clock and a rising sleep pressure built by adenosine (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch2). Going to bed early rides both at their fullest, which is why the first hours carry the largest share of deep sleep.

DO THIS TONIGHT. Set a lights-out time that lets you be in bed within an hour of praying Isha, and treat it as fixed as the prayer itself.

Habit 2: End the day's talk and turn to dhikr

THE SUNNAH. The dislike of pointless conversation after Isha was not silence for its own sake. The Prophet ﷺ would see to what mattered, then let the night close. Idle talk that eats the hours of rest was what he set aside.

THE SCIENCE. A racing, stimulated mind is one of the most common thieves of sleep onset. The single most reliable pre-sleep instruction in the clinical literature is to relax before bed, letting arousal fall rather than climb (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. In the last hour, close the group chat and the news feed and give ten unhurried minutes to remembrance instead.

Habit 3: Perform wudu before you lie down

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ said that when you go to your bed, perform the ablution as you would for prayer, then lie down. He made washing part of the act of going to sleep.

THE SCIENCE. Sleep onset is helped by a gentle drop in core temperature; warming then cooling the skin, especially hands and feet, helps the core shed heat and slip toward sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). Wudu is a nightly cue of exactly this kind.

DO THIS TONIGHT. Make your last act before bed a full wudu, unhurried, and lie down in that state.

THE WIND-DOWN

Habit 4: Finish your meal well before bed

THE SUNNAH. Moderation with food runs through the Prophet's ﷺ life; he warned against filling the stomach. This restraint is part of honoring the body, which has a right over you.

THE SCIENCE. A heavy meal or large volume of fluid close to bedtime works against sleep, loading the body with digestion when it should be settling (Walker, Why We Sleep, Appendix Tip 5).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Leave a clear gap between your last real meal and your bed, and keep the late snack and large drink out of the final stretch.

Habit 5: Settle the heart with tasbih before sleep

THE SUNNAH. When Fatima asked for help with her household's labor, the Prophet ﷺ taught her and Ali a remembrance to say on going to bed: to glorify Allah, praise Him, and proclaim His greatness a set number of times.

THE SCIENCE. Bedtime worry and a mind that will not stop are among the most common drivers of insomnia; a calm, repeated pre-sleep routine reduces that arousal (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. As you lie down, let a short, steady dhikr be the last thing on your tongue, repeated slowly until it carries you off.

Habit 6: Build one calm, repeatable closing ritual

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet's ﷺ nights were not improvised. He had an order to them: the washing, the dusting of the bed, the posture, the recitation, the words of submission said last of all.

THE SCIENCE. The brain learns by association. A consistent set of cues in the same order each night becomes a signal that sleep is coming, and the body begins to prepare before you lie down (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Choose three or four habits and do them in the same order every night. Let repetition turn them into a doorway your body knows.

SECTION TWO

The Bed & the Body

The posture, the room, and the physical shape of rest

The Prophet ﷺ paid attention to the small physical details of lying down: which side, where the hand rests, the state of the bed, the light in the room. None of it was fussiness. Each detail turns out to touch something the body needs.

THE BED & THE BODY

Habit 7: Dust off your bed before lying down

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that when one comes to his bed, he should dust it off with the inside of his garment and mention the name of Allah, for he does not know what came onto it after he left.

THE SCIENCE. Sleep is protected by a clean, orderly, comfortable surface; small discomforts fragment the night without our fully waking to notice (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Before you climb in, sweep the bed clean with your hand, say bismillah, and lie down in a space you have deliberately prepared.

Habit 8: Lie on your right side, hand under your cheek

THE SUNNAH. After wudu, the Prophet ﷺ taught, lie down on your right side. He himself would place his right hand under his cheek. It was his settled posture for sleep.

THE SCIENCE. A fixed, repeated way of lying down becomes one of the conditioned cues the brain uses to trigger the descent into sleep; consistency is itself restorative (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Turn onto your right side, rest your hand beneath your cheek, and let that be your fixed shape for sleep every night.

Habit 9: Keep your room cool

THE SUNNAH. No narration prescribes a temperature, so this sits under a principle: the body is an amanah, and creating conditions that let it rest is part of honoring that trust. The Prophet ﷺ chose simple, cool, uncluttered conditions.

THE SCIENCE. The body needs to lower its core temperature by roughly one degree to fall and stay asleep; a bedroom near eighteen degrees Celsius is close to ideal for most people (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Drop the thermostat a few degrees before bed and let the room run cooler than feels obvious.

THE BED & THE BODY

Habit 10: Take a warm wash before bed

THE SUNNAH. Washing before sleep was the Prophet's ﷺ practice. Cleanliness at the day's close was part of how he readied himself for rest.

THE SCIENCE. A warm bath or shower helps sleep, and the mechanism is the cooling that follows: bringing blood to the skin lets the body radiate heat afterward, dropping core temperature and deepening slow-wave sleep (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. If the night allows, take a warm shower before bed, then step into a cool room and let your body do the rest.

Habit 11: Lighten the bedding, let the body cool

THE SUNNAH. This falls under moderation and care for the body. The Prophet's ﷺ bedding was famously simple; excess and heaviness were not his way.

THE SCIENCE. Overheating under heavy bedding is a quiet disruptor of sleep, because it blocks the core cooling sleep depends on. Lighter covers, or uncovered feet, help the body vent heat (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Trade one heavy layer for a lighter one, or leave your feet free of the covers, and let your body find its cooler set point.

Habit 12: Avoid sleeping face-down

THE SUNNAH. It is reported the Prophet ﷺ saw a man on his stomach and guided him to his side or back. Because the narration's strength is debated, take it as a gentle prophetic preference rather than a firm command, and confirm it before relying on it.

THE SCIENCE. Sleep science does not single out the prone position, so the pairing is general: honoring the body means a posture that lets it breathe and rest easily through the night (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. If you tend to sleep face-down, start the night on your side instead, in keeping with the prophetic preference.

THE BED & THE BODY

Habit 13: Reserve the bed for sleep

THE SUNNAH. The Qur'an names the night a covering and sleep a rest, giving the night its own purpose. The bed, in that light, is a place set aside for rest, not a second desk.

THE SCIENCE. One of the strongest behavioral cures for poor sleep is to keep the bed for sleep alone, so the brain builds a clean association between that place and rest (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Do your working and scrolling somewhere else, and let the bed be a place your mind knows only for sleep.

SECTION THREE

Light & the Screen

The thief of the night, and how the Sunnah closes the door on it

The single largest change between the Prophet's ﷺ night and ours is light. He closed the day in darkness lit by a small flame he was told to put out; we bathe the final hour in bright, blue-white screens. The Sunnah's instinct to dim and extinguish maps almost exactly onto what science now urges.

LIGHT & THE SCREEN

Habit 14: Extinguish the lights, sleep in the dark

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that lamps and fires be put out before sleeping, along with closing doors and covering vessels. The night was to be darkened.

THE SCIENCE. Darkness tells the brain to release melatonin. As little as eight to ten lux, dimmer than most bedside lamps, can delay it, and ordinary dim room light can suppress it by around half (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Put out every light, cover the small glows of standby lamps and chargers, and sleep in genuine darkness.

Habit 15: Put the screen down an hour before bed

THE SUNNAH. The dislike of wakeful, idle activity after Isha covers, in spirit, carrying a bright screen into the last hour. The prophetic instinct was to let the night quiet down, not light up.

THE SCIENCE. Screens are the worst offenders because blue LED light suppresses melatonin at roughly twice the rate of warm light. Reading on a bright tablet before bed cut melatonin by around twenty-three percent, with a lingering digital hangover (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Set a screens-down time roughly an hour before bed and let the phone charge in another room.

Habit 16: Keep devices out of the bed

THE SUNNAH. Guarding the last hour is a small discipline of the nafs that would rather have one more scroll. The Prophet ﷺ modeled a night given to rest and remembrance, not restlessness.

THE SCIENCE. Around ninety percent of people use a device within the hour before bed, most often in bed itself (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). Keeping it out removes both the light and the temptation.

DO THIS TONIGHT. Charge your phone across the room, not on the pillow, and buy a cheap alarm clock so the phone has no excuse to be near you.

LIGHT & THE SCREEN

Habit 17: Dim and warm the evening light

THE SUNNAH. The prophetic night was lit, when at all, by a low flame soon extinguished. Lowering the light as the night deepened was simply how the world worked, and the Sunnah worked with it.

THE SCIENCE. Evening light can delay the internal clock by two to three hours by holding back melatonin, and ordinary indoor evening light produces roughly half the maximum suppression (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. In the final hour, switch off the bright overheads and use low, warm lamps instead.

Habit 18: Recite Ayat al-Kursi as your guard

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ taught that whoever recites Ayat al-Kursi when he lies down will have a protector from Allah through the night.

THE SCIENCE. The protection is from Allah; the calm that rides alongside it is a mercy. A heart that trusts its Guard can stop keeping watch, and reduced bedtime worry is one of the surest paths to faster, deeper sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Recite Ayat al-Kursi as you settle, and let its promise of protection quiet the mind for sleep.

Habit 19: Seal the night with the last two ayat of al-Baqarah

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ said that whoever recites the last two verses of al-Baqarah at night, they will be enough for him.

THE SCIENCE. Replacing a stimulating final input with a calm, familiar one is exactly the substitution sleep science recommends; what you feed the mind in the last minutes shapes how quickly it releases into sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Make these two verses the last thing you recite before sleep, in place of one last look at the phone.

Habit 20: Blow the muawwidhat over yourself

THE SUNNAH. Each night the Prophet ﷺ would cup his hands, recite al-Ikhlās and the two verses of refuge, blow into his palms, and wipe them over his body, beginning with his head and face, three times.

THE SCIENCE. A short, physical, always-in-the-same-order ritual is one of the most effective conditioned cues for sleep; the body learns the sequence means rest is coming (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Cup your hands, recite the three suras, blow into your palms, and wipe them over yourself three times as the last act of your night.

SECTION FOUR

The Rhythm of the Week

Regularity as worship, and the steady clock the body runs on

The believer's week already has a rhythm built into it: five prayers a day, a fixed dawn, a weekly gathering. Sleep science has landed on the same principle as its first and strongest advice. Regularity, more than any single trick, is what steadies the night.

THE RHYTHM OF THE WEEK

Habit 21: Wake at the same time every day

THE SUNNAH. Fajr anchors the believer's day to a fixed dawn. The Prophet ﷺ prayed for barakah in the early mornings of his ummah.

THE SCIENCE. A fixed wake time, kept every day including weekends, is the single most effective piece of sleep advice there is and the first-line treatment for insomnia (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13; Ch2).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Set one wake time you will honor every day of the week, and let Fajr be its anchor.

Habit 22: Don't bank weekend catch-up sleep

THE SUNNAH. The five daily prayers train steadiness rather than binges of devotion; the most beloved deeds are the consistent ones, even if small. That steadiness serves the body.

THE SCIENCE. Sleeping in on the weekend does not repay lost sleep and shifts the clock later, so Monday feels like self-inflicted jet lag (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 1).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Resist the weekend sleep-in. Keep your wake time steady across all seven days and get your sleep by going to bed earlier.

Habit 23: Rise on the first waking, skip the snooze

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ taught the believer to wake with gratitude and rise for the dawn. Waking was met with remembrance and movement, not delay.

THE SCIENCE. The snooze button subjects the body to repeated jolts of the stress response in the fragile minutes of waking; rising once, cleanly, spares you those shocks (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Set one alarm, place it across the room, and when it sounds, get up on the first call with a word of gratitude.

THE RHYTHM OF THE WEEK

Habit 24: Cut caffeine after the early afternoon

THE SUNNAH. This sits under moderation and guarding worship: nothing that quietly robs you of the night should be taken lightly. The Prophet ﷺ taught balance in the body's appetites.

THE SCIENCE. Caffeine has a half-life of five to seven hours and can take eight or more to clear, and it works by blocking the adenosine signal that makes you sleepy, masking tiredness without removing it (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch2).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Draw a line in the early afternoon after which you take no caffeine, and watch the hidden sources in tea, chocolate, and soft drinks.

Habit 25: Keep the night clear of intoxicants

THE SUNNAH. Intoxicants are forbidden in the Qur'an, named as defilement to be avoided. The believer's night is already clear of the nightcap the wider culture reaches for.

THE SCIENCE. Alcohol is a sedative, not a sleep aid; it fragments sleep into shallow pieces and is one of the most powerful suppressors of REM sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Take quiet confidence that the prohibition already guards your nights, and let nothing intoxicating stand between you and true sleep.

Habit 26: Move by day, not before bed

THE SUNNAH. The prophetic life was active, and the body's exertion belonged to daylight. Rest belonged to the night. Both were honored in their season.

THE SCIENCE. Regular exercise improves sleep, but not too close to bedtime; vigorous activity in the final two to three hours raises core temperature and alertness when both should be falling (Walker, Why We Sleep, Appendix Tip 2).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Get your real exertion done in daylight or early evening, and keep the final hours before bed calm and still.

THE RHYTHM OF THE WEEK

Habit 27: Get morning daylight

THE SUNNAH. Rising for Fajr places the believer in the first light of day, exactly when the body most needs it. The Prophet ﷺ asked Allah to bless those early hours.

THE SCIENCE. Morning light is the master reset for the internal clock. Daylight, ideally thirty minutes or more, early in the day sets the clock on time and strengthens the night's melatonin release (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch2).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Plan to step outside soon after you wake, and let real daylight, not a lamp, start your day.

Habit 28: Protect a full seven-to-nine-hour window

THE SUNNAH. Salman told Abu al-Darda that his body, his eyes, and his family each had a right over him; the Prophet ﷺ affirmed he had spoken the truth. Sleep is one of those rights, a support of worship, not a theft from it.

THE SCIENCE. After roughly nineteen to twenty-two hours awake, a person is as impaired as someone legally drunk; a single four-hour night can drop natural-killer immune-cell activity by around seventy percent (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch7; Ch8).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Count back seven to nine hours from your fixed wake time, and treat that bedtime as a boundary, not a suggestion.

SECTION FIVE

Rising in the Last Third

The nap that carries you, the du'a on your lips, and the pre-dawn hour

The prophetic night was built to turn toward its end. The believer sleeps not to escape the night but to be able to meet its most precious hours, when the world is quiet enough to hear yourself pray.

RIISING IN THE LAST THIRD

Habit 29: Take the midday nap (qaylulah)

THE SUNNAH. The midday nap was the practice of the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions, who rested briefly around the middle of the day. Confirm any specific narration you cite, as some wordings are discussed among scholars.

THE SCIENCE. Humans are naturally biphasic sleepers, wired for a long night and a short afternoon rest. A NASA study found a nap of around twenty-six minutes improved performance by thirty-four percent (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch4; Ch7).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Plan tomorrow's qaylulah: a short midday rest, in the tradition of the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions.

Habit 30: Keep the nap short and early

THE SUNNAH. The qaylulah of the Companions was a brief midday pause, not a long afternoon sleep. Its name and timing tie it to the middle of the day.

THE SCIENCE. A nap after mid-afternoon bleeds off the sleep pressure you need at night, and a short nap avoids the grogginess of waking from deep sleep (Walker, Why We Sleep, Appendix Tip 7).

DO THIS TONIGHT. If you nap, keep it to around twenty to thirty minutes and take it before mid-afternoon so it does not rob your night.

Habit 31: Sleep with your heart set on the last third

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ said our Lord descends to the lowest heaven when the last third of the night remains, saying: who is calling on Me that I may answer him. The night bends toward that hour.

THE SCIENCE. Sleeping early front-loads the deepest slow-wave sleep into the first half of the night, which is what makes it possible to wake refreshed in the pre-dawn hours (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch2; Ch3).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Go to sleep early with the intention to rise, even for a few minutes, in the last third, and let that intention shape your bedtime.

RISING IN THE LAST THIRD

Habit 32: Say the sleeping du'a as your last words

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ would say on lying down, “In Your name, O Allah, I die and I live,” placing his final words in remembrance and submission.

THE SCIENCE. Sleep and death share a doorway in the Qur'an, which calls sleep a kind of taking of the soul; science finds each night's sleep a genuine restoration the body cannot live without (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch6; Ch8).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Let the sleeping du'a be the last thing on your tongue, so remembrance is where your day ends.

Habit 33: Wake gently for tahajjud

THE SUNNAH. When the Prophet ﷺ rose in the night he would wipe the sleep from his face, look to the sky, and recite the closing verses of Al Imran before his prayer. He rose slowly, into remembrance.

THE SCIENCE. Waking naturally and easing into alertness spares the body the abrupt stress-spike of a jarring alarm (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13). A gentle rising is kinder to the waking brain and easier to sustain.

DO THIS TONIGHT. If you rise for qiyam, wake gently: sit up, wipe your face, look up, and let your first moments be quiet before you stand to pray.

Habit 34: Reach for the siwak on waking

THE SUNNAH. Whenever the Prophet ﷺ rose in the night, he would clean his mouth thoroughly with the siwak before anything else.

THE SCIENCE. A small, physical, cleansing act on waking helps the body cross from sleep into alertness, one more familiar cue that the day has begun (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Keep a siwak, or a brush, within reach of the bed, and make cleaning your mouth the first thing you do on waking.

RISING IN THE LAST THIRD

Habit 35: If sleep flees, rise to remembrance

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ taught that whoever wakes in the night and says the words of tawhid and praise, then prays, will have his prayer accepted. Wakefulness was turned toward Allah, not frustration.

THE SCIENCE. Lying awake and frustrated teaches the brain to associate the bed with wakefulness; the standard advice is to get up after around twenty minutes, do something calm in dim light, and return only when sleepy (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Appendix Tip 12).

DO THIS TONIGHT. If sleep will not come, do not lie there straining. Get up, turn to quiet remembrance, and return to bed only when your eyes grow heavy.

SECTION SIX

The Family Night

The household at rest, from the youngest to the oldest

A home has a night of its own. The Prophet ﷺ closed his household for the night with care, taught the young their bedtime words, and moved through the evening with gentleness. A peaceful house is where peaceful sleep begins.

THE FAMILY NIGHT

Habit 36: Close the house for the night

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ instructed that at nightfall you bring in the children, close the doors and mention Allah's name, cover the vessels, and put out the lamps.

THE SCIENCE. A dark, quiet, safe, orderly environment is one of the foundations of good sleep for everyone under the roof; small disturbances of light and noise fragment the whole household's night (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch13).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Make a small nightly round: gather the children, lower the lights, secure the doors, and let the whole house know the day is done.

Habit 37: Tuck the children in with the Sunnah

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ was tender with children and taught the household its bedtime protections, blowing the verses of refuge over his family and teaching the young the remembrances of sleep.

THE SCIENCE. Children today sleep on the order of two hours less per night than a century ago; protecting their sleep supports the brain maturation and pruning that deep sleep drives in the young (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch15; Ch5).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Make your children's bedtime unhurried and consistent: the adhkar, the verses of refuge, a calm word, and lights out at a steady hour.

Habit 38: Honor the teenager's later clock

THE SUNNAH. Gentleness and mercy in dealing with family were the Prophet's ﷺ way. Meeting a young person's real needs with rifq, rather than rebuke, is part of that.

THE SCIENCE. A teenager's internal clock genuinely shifts later during adolescence; it is biology, not laziness. Where schools honored this with later start times, teen car crashes dropped steeply (Walker, Why We Sleep, Ch5; Ch15).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Ease the pressure on a teenager's night with understanding rather than blame, and protect their morning sleep where you can.

THE FAMILY NIGHT

Habit 39: Greet the morning with gratitude

THE SUNNAH. On waking, the Prophet ﷺ would say, “All praise is for Allah who gave us life after He caused us to die, and to Him is the return,” meeting the new day with thankfulness first.

THE SCIENCE. A consistent, positive morning ritual reinforces a steady wake time, and that steadiness is the anchor that holds the whole sleep-wake rhythm in place (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch2).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Prepare to make gratitude your first waking thought, and let the household hear the day begin with thanks rather than complaint.

Habit 40: Let the household's night be gentle and shared

THE SUNNAH. The Prophet ﷺ shared the evening with his family, spoke kindly, and taught even the labor of the home to be closed with remembrance, as he taught Ali and Fatima the tasbih of the night.

THE SCIENCE. REM sleep is the brain's overnight emotional first aid; a peaceful, unstrained evening lets everyone reach that repair rather than carrying the day's tension into the dark (Walker, *Why We Sleep*, Ch7; Ch10; Ch11).

DO THIS TONIGHT. Let your household's last hour be soft: kind words, no unfinished arguments carried to bed, and a shared quiet that lets everyone sleep in peace.

Your Prophetic Night at a Glance

You do not need all forty at once. Begin with three.

AS THE EVENING WINDS DOWN

- ☐ Pray Isha and head toward bed within the hour
- ☐ Trade screens and idle talk for quiet remembrance in the last hour
- ☐ Finish your last real meal well before bed
- ☐ Dim and warm the lights; put out the bright overheads

AS YOU PREPARE THE ROOM AND BODY

- ☐ Take a warm wash, then let the room run cool
- ☐ Cool room, lighter bedding, feet free to vent heat
- ☐ Charge the phone in another room; keep the bed for sleep

AS YOU MAKE WUDU AND LIE DOWN

- ☐ Perform wudu as for prayer
- ☐ Dust off the bed, say bismillah
- ☐ Lie on your right side, hand under your cheek
- ☐ Recite Ayat al-Kursi
- ☐ Recite the last two ayat of al-Baqarah
- ☐ Cup and blow the three suras, wipe over yourself three times
- ☐ Close with the sleeping du'a as your last words

At a Glance, continued

One quiet night at a time.

ACROSS THE WEEK

- ☐ One fixed wake time, all seven days, anchored to Fajr
- ☐ No weekend catch-up sleep; no snooze
- ☐ No caffeine after early afternoon
- ☐ Real movement by day, calm in the final hours
- ☐ Morning daylight soon after waking
- ☐ A short qaylulah before mid-afternoon
- ☐ Protect a seven-to-nine-hour window

TOWARD THE LAST THIRD

- ☐ Sleep early, heart set on rising
- ☐ Wake gently; siwak first; wipe the face, look up
- ☐ If sleep flees, rise to remembrance, return when heavy
- ☐ Greet the morning with gratitude

FOR THE HOUSEHOLD

- ☐ Close the house: children in, doors closed, lamps out, names of Allah said
- ☐ Tuck the children in with the adhkar
- ☐ Honor the teenager's later clock with mercy
- ☐ Keep the last hour of the home gentle and shared

A NOTE ON SOURCES

References & the Citation Gate

On the science. The scientific findings are drawn from Matthew Walker, *Why We Sleep* (Scribner, 2017), used as cited facts and rewritten entirely in DailySunnah's own words. No passage is reproduced; facts are cited inline by chapter. Every load-bearing number is flagged for re-confirmation against the print edition before publication.

On the scripture. Every Qur'anic verse and every hadith is PENDING the standard DailySunnah human citation gate. Nothing is confirmed until a human reviewer verifies the reference, the wording, and, for hadith, the grading against sunnah.com and the Qur'an against quran.com. Where a narration's authenticity is discussed among scholars, it is described gently and flagged rather than asserted. No hadith has been invented or assigned a grading in this draft.

The Prophetic Night. May Allah make our nights a mercy, our sleep a rest, and our rising a return to Him. Ameen.